

Parenting

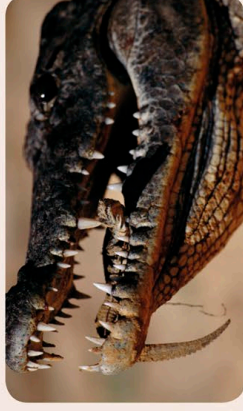
Some dinosaurs were good parents, treating their eggs and babies with great care and attention. Fossils have shown that a few parents stayed with their eggs to keep them warm and to protect them against predators. When the eggs hatched, these dinosaurs fed and helped their young until they were able to take care of themselves.

Citipati

In the 1990s this fossilized Citipati was found guarding its eggs, and was nicknamed "Big Mama." Its position is like a modern bird sitting on its eggs in a nest. Citipati was a feathered dinosaur and it may have been incubating its eggs, keeping them warm until they hatched. Later research has shown this dinosaur was probably the father, not the mother, of the eggs.

Staying safe

Today there are plenty of good parents in the animal kingdom. Crocodile mothers carry their babies from the nest to the safety of the water, while ostrich mothers and fathers watch over their chicks in a group, like children in a nursery.



A mother crocodile carefully holds a baby in her mouth.



Baby ostriches stay in a group for safety.

A baby Citipati would have used its beak to crack through its eggshell.

